

Friday, 14 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

33° 23°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

31° 20°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

28° 18°

GLASGOW

Light rain

21° 16°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Two people have been jailed for killing men they drugged in 'honeytrap' robberies.

Adina Mihai and Madalin Dumitru targeted their victims, giving them a powerful drug to render them unconscious before stealing from them. The court heard the drug GBL can be lethal, even in small doses.

CRIME · UK

2

The UK government is defending its decision to seize a 'shadow fleet' oil tanker, following threats from Russia.

The vessel, thought to be involved in transporting Russian oil, was intercepted in accordance with maritime law. The UK says it's part of an effort to disrupt and deter illegal shipping activities.

POLITICS · UK

3

A woman accused of owning an XL bully dog that fatally bit a man has told a court the animal was not aggressive.

Chanel Fong is on trial after her partner's father died from blood loss following a dog attack. She claims the dog, which was seized by police, wasn't the type to savage anyone.

CRIME · UK

4

Voters in Clacton are heading to the polls today for a by-election, with a record number of candidates standing.

Thirty-four hopefuls are vying for the seat, making it the largest field in any British parliamentary election. It's expected to be a closely watched contest.

POLITICS · UK

5

A leading doctor has criticised NHS chiefs over ongoing failings in the organ transplant system.

The medical director of NHS Blood and Transplant said waiting lists for operations are unfairly long. He argues that leaders aren't doing enough to address the critical issues.

HEALTH · UK

What's coming up

- 1 The Eurovision Song Contest 2027 will be held in Burgas, Bulgaria, it's been announced.**
The Black Sea city was chosen after Bulgarian singer Dara won this year's contest, securing her country the right to host. Fans are already buzzing about the seaside location.
ON AIR – Are you excited for Eurovision in Bulgaria? What's your favourite Eurovision host city ever?
MUSIC · 2027
- 2 British actor David Jonsson is being celebrated by fans and stars alike as the 'new Black Panther'.**
He's set to play the son of T'Challa, the King of Wakanda, in the third film in the hugely successful Marvel series. It's a massive role for the rising star.
ON AIR – What do you think of David Jonsson stepping into such a huge role? Who would you love to see join the Marvel universe?
FILM · COMING UP
- 3 Travis Kelce has shared the first details of his wedding to Taylor Swift, calling it the 'best night of his life'.**
In a social media comment, Kelce referred to Swift as his 'wife' for the first time, revealing it was a 'childhood dream' to marry at Madison Square Garden. Congratulations to the happy couple!
ON AIR – What's the most romantic wedding venue you can imagine? Or what's your dream wedding location?
CELEBRITY · RECENT
- 4 Fans of Phoebe Bridgers have been treated to an early listen of her unreleased album, at a planetarium!**
Armagh Planetarium in Northern Ireland hosted a special listening party for the American singer-songwriter's new music. Attendees were reportedly 'blown away' by the unique experience.
ON AIR – What's the most unusual place you've ever listened to music? Or where would you love to hear an album for the first time?
MUSIC · COMING UP
- 5 Acting friends Alan Cumming and Shirley Henderson are bringing their 40-year friendship to the screen.**
The pair, who have known each other for decades, are reuniting for a new show that mirrors their long-standing relationship. It sounds like a lovely project!
ON AIR – Who's your oldest friend, and what's the secret to your lasting friendship?
TV · COMING UP

On the schedule

- 1 **Iga Swiatek has reached her first final of what she's called her 'toughest season' at the Canadian Open.**
The world number one battled through her semi-final in three sets, and will now face Elena Rybakina in the final. It's a huge test for Swiatek as she looks to end her season strongly.

ON AIR – Who do you think will take home the title at the Canadian Open? And what's been your favourite tennis moment of the year?

TENNIS · UK

- 2 **Great Britain's Emily Newnham has secured a brilliant silver medal in the women's 400m hurdles.**
Newnham ran a personal best at the European Championships in Birmingham, adding to her Commonwealth Games silver. What a 'wonderful run' from the British athlete!

ON AIR – What's your favourite athletic event to watch? And which British athlete are you most excited about right now?

ATHLETICS · UK

- 3 **Great Britain's Keely Hodgkinson has comfortably won her 800m semi-final, qualifying for the final.**
She led home Femke Broeders-Bol of the Netherlands in a strong performance. Hodgkinson will now be aiming for gold in the highly anticipated final.

ON AIR – Do you think Keely Hodgkinson can win gold in the 800m final? What's your favourite track and field event?

ATHLETICS · UK

- 4 **Tottenham captain Cristian Romero is set to join Atletico Madrid in a £34.2 million deal.**
The La Liga side has agreed a fee with Spurs for the defender. It's a big move for Romero and a significant transfer for both clubs.

ON AIR – What do you make of this transfer? Do you think Romero will be a good fit for Atletico Madrid?

FOOTBALL · UK

- 5 **Paris Saint-Germain have beaten Aston Villa in the UEFA Super Cup, with goals from Kvaratskhelia and Doue.**
It was a 2-1 victory for PSG, though Villa's 17-year-old Brian Madjo scored an 'eye-catching' debut goal. A tough night for Villa, but a moment to remember for Madjo!

ON AIR – What did you make of the Super Cup final? And how exciting is it to see young talent like Brian Madjo emerge?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people creating 'miniature libraries' inside old telephone boxes across the country.**
These charming, community-led projects allow locals to swap books, fostering a love for reading and repurposing iconic British structures.
- 2 The delightful practice of 'wild swimming' in rivers and lakes is experiencing a surge in popularity, with many discovering its health benefits.**
Enthusiasts report improved mood and physical vigour, embracing the refreshing chill of natural waters safely and respectfully.
- 3 Gardeners are increasingly turning to 'heirloom vegetable varieties', celebrating unique flavours and preserving genetic diversity.**
These heritage seeds offer a delightful taste of the past, often with more robust flavours than their modern counterparts.
- 4 The simple pleasure of 'writing and sending handwritten letters' is making a heartening comeback, connecting people in a more personal way.**
Many are rediscovering the joy of receiving something tangible and thoughtful through the post, beyond bills and junk mail.
- 5 A charming movement encouraging 'random acts of kindness' is gaining traction in local communities.**
From paying for a stranger's coffee to leaving encouraging notes, these small gestures are spreading warmth and goodwill.
- 6 The humble 'picnic blanket' is seeing a stylish revival, with people investing in high-quality, comfortable designs for outdoor dining.**
Gone are the days of just an old rug; now, picnics are a truly comfortable and fashionable affair, perfect for parks and beaches.
- 7 Research highlights the positive impact of 'spending time near water' on mental well-being and stress reduction.**
Whether it's a bustling riverside or a peaceful coastal path, the calming effect of water is proving to be incredibly restorative.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our perfectly good teabags, even though we know we probably shouldn't?

ANSWER: USING THEM FOR A SECOND CUPPA, JUST TO SEE IF THERE'S ANY LIFE LEFT IN THEM!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh packet of biscuits. What is it?

ANSWER: ARRANGING THEM INTO A NEAT PATTERN BEFORE DARING TO TAKE THE FIRST ONE!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'sound from your childhood' can instantly bring back a flood of happy memories?
From the ice cream van jingle to the clatter of a specific toy, what sound instantly takes you back to being a child?
- We all have those 'little rituals' we perform before embarking on a journey, whether it's a daily commute or a grand adventure.
What's your essential 'pre-travel ritual' that you just can't do without?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of owls is actually called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The shortest distance between two points is sometimes called a 'bee-line' because bees always fly in perfectly straight lines.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£3.5 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.5 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's first public park was Birkenhead Park, near Liverpool, opening in 1847 and influencing New York's Central Park.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, which have chemoreceptors that help them find host plants and nectar.
- The inventor of the refreshing 'popsicle' was an 11-year-old boy named Frank Epperson in 1905.
- The national animal of Scotland is the unicorn, a symbol of purity, innocence, and power.
- The oldest continuously inhabited city in the UK is Colchester, with evidence of settlement dating back to the Bronze Age.
- A 'gallimaufry' is an old English word for a confused jumble or medley of things.
- The iconic 'red post box' was first introduced in the British Isles on the island of Jersey in 1852.
- Strawberries are the only fruit with seeds on the outside.

On this day

Day 226 of the year, 139 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Arnold of Soissons; Christian feast day: Domingo Ibáñez de Erquicia; Christian feast day: Eusebius of Rome; Christian feast day: Fachtna of Rosscarbery. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1984 — Nicola Slater, Scottish tennis player
- 1984 — Nick Grimshaw, English radio and television host
- 1926 — Buddy Greco, American singer and pianist (died 2017)
- 1946 — Susan Saint James, American actress
- 1947 — Maddy Prior, English folk singer
- 1945 — Steve Martin, American actor, comedian, musician, producer, and screenwriter
- 1983 — Elena Baltacha, Ukrainian-Scottish tennis player (died 2014)
- 1946 — Antonio Fargas, American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1941 — World War II: Winston Churchill and Franklin D. Roosevelt sign the Atlantic Charter of war stating postwar aims.
- 1980 — Lech Wałęsa leads strikes at the Gdańsk, Poland shipyards.
- 2007 — The Kahtaniya bombings kill at least 500 people.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1980 — Lech Wałęsa leads strikes at the Gdańsk, Poland shipyards.
- 1959 — Founding and first official meeting of the American Football League.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1996 — Greek Cypriot refugee Solomos Solomou is shot and killed by a Turkish security officer while trying to climb a flagpole in order to remove a Turkish flag from its mast in the United Nations Buffer Zone in Cyprus.
- 1994 — Ilich Ramírez Sánchez, also known as "Carlos the Jackal", is captured.

- 2022 — An explosion destroys a market in Armenia, killing six people and injuring dozens.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 227 of the year, 138 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Poland); Christian feast day: Altfrid; Christian feast day: Alypius of Thagaste; Christian feast day: Feast day of the Assumption of Mary, one of the Catholic holy days of obligation (a public holiday in Austria, Belgium, Benin, Bosnia, Burundi, Cameroon, Chile, Colombia, Croatia, Cyprus, France, some states in Germany, Greece, Guatemala, Italy, Ivory Coast, Lebanon, Liechtenstein, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Madagascar, Malta, Mauritius, Paraguay, Poland, Portugal, Romania, Senegal, Seychelles, Slovenia, Spain, Switzerland, Togo, and Vanuatu); and its related observances: Feast of the Dormition of the Theotokos (Eastern Orthodox, Oriental Orthodox and Eastern Catholic Churches). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1989 — Carlos PenaVega, American actor and singer
- 1961 — Matt Johnson, English singer-songwriter and musician
- 1951 — Bobby Caldwell, American singer-songwriter (died 2023)
- 1983 — Siobhan Chamberlain, English association football goalkeeper
- 1967 — Peter Hermann, American actor
- 1970 — Anthony Anderson, American comedian, actor, and producer
- 1993 — Alex Oxlade-Chamberlain, English footballer
- 1990 — Jennifer Lawrence, American actress and producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2015 — North Korea moves its clock back half an hour to introduce Pyongyang Time, ⁸/₂ hours ahead of UTC.
- 1998 — Northern Ireland: Omagh bombing takes place; 29 people (including a woman pregnant with twins) killed and some 220 others injured.
- 2005 — Israel's unilateral disengagement plan to evict all Israelis from the Gaza Strip and from four settlements in the northern West Bank begins.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1882 — Start of the second part of the Montceau-les-Mines troubles by the Black Band, groups of anarchist miners.
- 1976 — SAETA Flight 011 crashes into the Chimborazo volcano in Ecuador, killing all 59 people on board; the wreckage is not discovered until 2002.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

SAT 15 Premier League season begins (2026/27)

22–23 Belgian Grand Prix (F1)